

Reading and Writing—Module 2

1. Which quote from *Metamorphosis* by Franz Kafka most effectively illustrates the claim that individuals living in modern society can experience isolation and dehumanization?

Metamorphosis by Franz Kafka

Metamorphosis, written by Franz Kafka and first published in 1915, is a seminal work of 20th-century literature. This novella delves into the surreal and nightmarish world of its protagonist, Gregor Samsa, who undergoes a bizarre transformation into a gigantic insect. Set against a backdrop of alienation and existential absurdity, Kafka's work explores themes of identity, isolation, and the dehumanizing effects of modern society. *Metamorphosis* remains a thought-provoking and enduring exploration of the human condition, and it has left a lasting impact on literature and existential philosophy.

- A) "Calm —indeed the calmest— reflection might be better than the most confused decisions"
- B) "I only fear danger where I want to fear it."
- C) "One morning, upon awakening from agitated dreams, Gregor Samsa found himself, in his bed, transformed into a monstrous vermin."
- D) "The door could not be heard slamming; they had probably left it open, as is the custom in homes where a great misfortune has occurred."

2. Based on the texts, what would the author of text 1 most likely say about the experiments described in text 2?

Passage 1: The Impact of Environmental Pollution on Ecosystems

Our environment faces a grave threat from pollution, with various harmful substances like heavy metals, pesticides, and industrial chemicals contaminating our air, water, and soil. These pollutants are causing widespread damage, leading to the decline or extinction of many species and affecting their ability to reproduce and thrive. Pollutants like lead, DDT, and mercury are some of the culprits behind these adverse effects, and it's imperative that we delve into how they harm our ecosystems to find effective ways to protect them.

Passage 2: Research in Bioremediation Techniques

Scientists are hard at work running experiments to combat pollution. They're using specific microorganisms, like *Pseudomonas* bacteria and mycorrhizal fungi, to clean up contaminated environments, especially those polluted by substances like petroleum hydrocarbons, chlorinated solvents, and heavy metals. These microorganisms can break down and metabolize these specific pollutants, which helps our ecosystems heal and regain their natural balance.

- A) The experiments in text 2 provide valuable insights into the potential solutions for addressing environmental pollution.
- B) The experiments in text 2 are unrelated to the topic of environmental pollution and its effects on ecosystems as discussed in text 1.
- C) The experiments in text 2 contradict the claims made in text 1, presenting conflicting data regarding the impact of pollutants on ecosystems.
- D) The experiments in text 2 primarily focus on the use of specific microorganisms without any practical application for ecological restoration.

3. How might Author 2 from Passage 2 respond to Author 1 from Passage 1 regarding their respective topics?

Passage 1: Cultural Significance of Traditional Clothing

Traditional clothing holds a profound significance in representing identity, heritage, and values in various cultures. These garments often incorporate intricate designs and colors that convey historical narratives and social roles. For example, in many Native American communities, regalia worn during powwows features intricate beadwork and symbolism, reflecting the cultural history and spiritual beliefs of the wearers. Similarly, the vibrant, handwoven fabrics of West African clothing tell stories of tribal origins and social standing.

Passage 2: Art and Social Movements

Artistic expression has been a powerful tool in promoting social change and challenging the status quo. Street art, in particular, has gained prominence as a means of addressing societal issues. Graffiti artists, like Banksy, have used their work to draw attention to political injustices and inequalities. These artworks can serve as a form of protest and commentary, much like music in the civil rights movement.

- A) Author 2 would argue that street art is a more effective means of cultural representation than traditional clothing.
- B) Author 2 would suggest that the cultural significance of traditional clothing extends to street art.
- C) Author 2 would emphasize that both traditional clothing and street art convey historical narratives.
- D) Author 2 would likely concur that traditional clothing and street art are unrelated in their cultural significance.

4. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

Lighthouses, with their towering structures and guiding beacons, hold profound symbolism in the maritime world. Serving as literal beacons, these iconic structures guide ships safely through treacherous waters. The significance of lighthouses extends beyond the maritime realm. _____, lighthouses are often used in poetry as a metaphor for safety and comfort. They convey a timeless message of resilience and human ingenuity, offering a broader representation of strength and reliability and guiding the way to safety in challenging circumstances.

- A) Therefore
- B) Nonetheless
- C) In contrast
- D) For example

5. What does the text most strongly suggest about the importance of iPhones?

iPhones, produced by Apple Inc., are iconic smartphones that have fundamentally transformed modern life. With their sleek design and cutting-edge technology, iPhones are celebrated for their user-friendly interfaces and continuous innovation. These devices serve as more than just phones, functioning as digital assistants, entertainment centers, and productivity tools. The iPhone's integrated ecosystem, including the App Store and a commitment to privacy and security, has made it a central part of daily life, symbolizing innovation, quality, and style in the digital age.

- A) iPhones are primarily used as basic communication devices.
- B) iPhones prioritize third-party apps.
- C) iPhones offer innovation, functionality, and style.
- D) iPhones serve as digital assistants and entertainment hubs.

6. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

Dance is a universal language that transcends boundaries and cultures. It's a form of artistic expression that has been a part of human history for centuries, evolving in countless ways. From classical ballet to contemporary hip-hop, dance encompasses a wide range of styles and techniques. Dancers use their bodies as instruments to convey emotions, tell stories, and communicate without words. The physical and mental benefits of dance are numerous, promoting physical fitness, flexibility, and emotional well-being. But how can we further encourage dance as an accessible and inclusive art form, _____

- A) by providing opportunities for all to experience its joys and benefits.
- B) by providing opportunities for all to experience its joys and benefits?
- C) providing opportunities for all to experience its joys and benefits.
- D) providing opportunities for all to experience its joys and benefits?

7. Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

The Industrial Revolution, a transformative period in the 18th and 19th centuries, had far-reaching implications for the humanities. Mechanization and urbanization fundamentally reshaped the fabric of society, triggering tumultuous changes that reverberated across all aspects of life. In response, artists and writers endeavored to capture the human experience within this transformation. Visionaries like J.M.W. Turner, sought to portray the stark beauty and chaos of industrial landscapes through their art, while authors such as Charles Dickens delved into the heart of the social and moral challenges faced by the working class. These creative works not only documented the era's _____ but also raised questions about the impact of industrialization on humanity's relationship with nature, labor, and society.

- A) insignificance
- B) stagnation
- C) upheaval
- D) tranquility

8. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

Volcanic infrasound, low-frequency sound waves produced by volcanoes, is invaluable for studying volcanic activity. _____, detected by specialized instruments, reveal insights into volcanic processes like magma movement, gas emissions, and potential eruptions. This research aids in volcano monitoring and early warning systems, enhancing our understanding of volcanic behavior and risk reduction.

- A) These infrasound waves
- B) This infrasound wave
- C) It's infrasound waves
- D) Their infrasound waves

9. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

War and Peace by Leo Tolstoy

"Never, never marry, my dear fellow! That's my _____ marry till you can say to yourself that you have done all you are capable of, and until you have ceased to love the woman of your choice and have seen her plainly as she is, or else you will make a cruel and irrevocable mistake."

- A) advice, never
- B) advice. Never
- C) advice: never
- D) advice; never

10. The student wants to provide an explanation and example of Picasso's involvement in the Cubist movement. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes to accomplish this goal?

While researching a well-known artist's career, a student has gathered the following notes:

- The Spanish artist Pablo Picasso is famous for his contributions to the art world.
- He co-founded the Cubist movement, a groundbreaking art style.
- *Les Femmes d'Alger* is one of Picasso's iconic paintings.
- This painting is considered a masterpiece of the Cubist style.
- Juan Gris, a prominent figure in the Cubist movement, was known for his analytical and synthetic Cubism, which explored different facets of the style.
- Picasso's art in the Rose Period featured *Family of Saltimbanques* and *The Acrobat*.

- A) Pablo Picasso, a renowned Spanish artist, is celebrated for co-founding the innovative Cubist movement, with *Les Femmes d'Alger* as one of the iconic masterpieces that exemplifies this style.
- B) Juan Gris's artistic contributions include his co-founding of the Cubist movement, with *Les Femmes d'Alger* being a prime illustration of this revolutionary style.
- C) The Cubist movement by Pablo Picasso left an enduring mark on the art world. During his Rose Period, Picasso created notable works like *Family of Saltimbanques* and *The Acrobat*.
- D) Spanish artist Pablo Picasso played a pivotal role in the formation of the groundbreaking Cubist movement, where prominent figures like Juan Gris explored various facets of the style in paintings like *Les Femmes d'Alger*.

11. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

Soldiers, sailors, airmen, and marines undergo rigorous training to develop the skills and mental fortitude required for their roles. They learn to operate complex machinery, execute strategic maneuvers, and adapt to challenging environments _____ upholding the core values of honor, duty, and integrity.

- A) all the while
- B) while
- C) all while
- D) while still

12. Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

The human brain's intricacies in memory formation and retrieval are subjects of intense research. Memories begin with encoding in the hippocampus, which converts short-term memories into long-term ones. These memories are stored in different brain regions based on their type. Episodic memories _____ in the prefrontal cortex, while procedural memories are stored in the cerebellum. Memory retrieval involves reactivating specific neural pathways, which are influenced by factors like emotions and environmental cues. This research holds promise for treating memory-related disorders and enhancing memory function.

- A) disintegrate
- B) formulate
- C) annihilate
- D) reside

13. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

In the heart of town, a quaint park provided a serene retreat, complete with a fountain at its center and well-tended flowerbeds. _____ was a place where friends gathered, children played, and artists found inspiration in the surroundings.

- A) It
- B) They're
- C) Their
- D) It's

14. Which choice best describes data from the table that support the researchers' claim?

Star Name	Luminosity	Temperature	Size
Star A	High	Hot	Large
Star B	Low	Cool	Small
Star C	Medium	Warm	Medium
Star D	High	Hot	Large
Star E	Low	Cool	Small

A team of astronomers, spanning observatories across the Northern and Southern Hemispheres, embarked on a groundbreaking study to investigate the characteristics of various types of stars in our galaxy. Their research revealed that while stars differ significantly in terms of their luminosity, temperature, and size, there is a remarkable consistency in the underlying physical processes driving their energy production. As a result, they claim that a star's luminosity and temperature affect its size.

- A) Among the five stars in the table, stars with low luminosity (e.g., Star B and Star E) also tend to have low temperatures and small sizes.
- B) Star C has a temperature similar to that of Star D but a much larger size, indicating that temperature alone doesn't necessarily correlate with star size.
- C) Stars with high luminosity (e.g., Star A and Star D) do not always exhibit high temperatures or result in the largest sizes, contradicting the assumption that luminosity directly determines star size.
- D) Star B and Star E share low luminosity and low temperatures but have different sizes, highlighting that temperature and luminosity alone do not solely determine star size.

15. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

The Great Depression was a period of profound economic hardship that gripped the United States and much of the world in the 1930s. It was a time of immense suffering, marked by widespread unemployment, poverty, and despair. The causes of the Great Depression were multifaceted, stemming from a stock market crash in 1929, a banking crisis, and a severe drought that devastated American agriculture. These events set off a chain reaction, _____ to a massive economic downturn.

- A) leading
- B) leaded
- C) leads
- D) which leads

16. According to the text, what is true about Mother?

Peter Pan by J. M. Barrie:

Of course they lived at 14, and until Wendy came her mother was the chief one. She was a lovely lady, with a romantic mind and such a sweet mocking mouth. Her romantic mind was like the tiny boxes, one within the other, that come from the puzzling East, however many you discover there is always one more; and her sweet mocking mouth had one kiss on it that Wendy could never get, though there it was, perfectly conspicuous in the right-hand corner.

- A) She was a strict and overbearing parent.
- B) She was a brilliant mathematician.
- C) She had a delightful personality with a mind full of imagination and a playful demeanor.
- D) She had a romantic mind, and her kiss was always easily attainable.

17. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

Famous authors like William Shakespeare, Jane Austen, and Mark Twain have gained international acclaim for their literary contributions, leaving an indelible mark on the world of literature. _____, lesser-recognized but equally talented writers like Zora Neale Hurston, Kazuo Ishiguro, and Octavia Butler have produced exceptional works that are sometimes hidden in the shadows of their more celebrated counterparts. While the literary canon often highlights a select few, there is an abundance of hidden gems waiting to be discovered by avid readers.

- A) Similarly
- B) For instance
- C) In particular
- D) On the other hand

18. The student wants to provide an explanation and an example of oceanomics. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes to accomplish this goal?

While researching a topic, a student has taken the following notes:

- Dr. Lisa Patel is a marine biologist based in Miami.
- She coined the term *oceanomics* to describe her research approach, combining oceanography and genomics.
- Oceanomics aims to study the genetic diversity of marine life and its connection to ocean ecosystems.
- Her study “Coral Genomes” is a notable example of oceanomics.

- A) Dr. Lisa Patel, a marine biologist in Miami, introduced the term *oceanomics* to describe her research approach, which combines oceanography and genomics.
- B) Oceanomics, a research approach by Dr. Lisa Patel, explores the genetic diversity of marine life and its relationship to ocean ecosystems.
- C) Dr. Lisa Patel’s “Coral Genomes” study is a prominent example of oceanomics, a term she coined for her research blending oceanography and genomics.
- D) In Miami, Dr. Lisa Patel practices oceanomics, a research approach that explores the connection between marine genetic diversity and ocean ecosystems, which she named herself.

19. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

The study of genetics has revolutionized our understanding of heredity and inheritance. Prior to the discovery of DNA's structure, scientists had limited knowledge of how traits were passed from one generation to the next. _____ the elucidation of the DNA's double helix structure by James Watson and Francis Crick in 1953, genetics research advanced significantly, as this breakthrough enabled scientists to delve into the molecular underpinnings of genetics and explore the mechanisms behind trait inheritance.

- A) In contrast to
- B) Before
- C) As a result of
- D) Despite

20. Which choice most logically completes the text?

In a recent study on the effects of daily meditation, researchers found that participants who meditated for at least 20 minutes a day reported significant reductions in stress and anxiety levels. The study collected data from a diverse group of individuals, and the results indicate a strong correlation between the frequency of meditation and improved mental well-being. Participants also reported better sleep quality and enhanced emotional regulation as secondary benefits of their meditation practice. This study _____.

- A) conclusively proves that meditation is the ultimate solution to all mental health issues
- B) reveals that daily meditation can improve your mental health and well-being
- C) shows that the results should be completely disregarded, as they lack scientific validity and rigor
- D) indicates that benefits were found to be highly dependent on the individual's level of meditation experience

21. Which choice best states the main purpose of the text?

A Tale of Two Cities by Charles Dickens:

For you, and for any dear to you, I would do anything. If my career were of that better kind that there was any opportunity or capacity of sacrifice in it, I would embrace any sacrifice for you and for those dear to you. Try to hold me in your mind, at some quiet times, as ardent and sincere in this one thing. The time will come, the time will not be long in coming, when new ties will be formed about you--ties that will bind you yet more tenderly and strongly to the home you so adorn--the dearest ties that will ever grace and gladden you. O Miss Manette, when the little picture of a happy father's face looks up in yours, when you see your own bright beauty springing up anew at your feet, think now and then that there is a man who would give his life, to keep a life you love beside you!

- A) To provide a detailed description of Miss Manette's appearance and personality
- B) To express deep love and devotion to Miss Manette and a willingness to make sacrifices for her
- C) To express concerns about Miss Manette's choices and actions, highlighting potential consequences
- D) To reflect on the complexities of life and the challenges of forming new bonds in the future

22. Which choice most logically completes the text?

Throughout history, empires and dynasties have risen and fallen, leaving their indelible marks on the world. These powerful entities have shaped societies, cultures, and economies in significant ways, often leaving legacies that persist for centuries. The rise of the Roman Empire, for instance, was marked by its remarkable engineering feats, governance systems, and widespread influence over vast territories. Similarly, the Ming Dynasty in China, known for its cultural achievements, introduced innovations such as the printing press and expeditions of maritime exploration that had a lasting impact. The annals of history are replete with examples of these transformative periods, providing invaluable insights into human civilization's development because _____.

- A) they prove that empires and dynasties are the only driving forces behind human civilization's development
- B) they reveal the insignificance of empires and dynasties in shaping human civilization
- C) they offer valuable lessons and insights into the progression of human civilization over time
- D) they illustrate the enduring effects of past civilizations on our world today

23. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A dedicated team from the MARUM - Center for Marine Environmental Sciences at the University of Bremen recently embarked on a remarkable journey. Through ingenious flume-tank experiments, they sought to uncover how currents sculpt the ocean floor and dictate sediment patterns, a key to understanding our marine history. Recently unveiled in the journal *Communications Earth & Environment*, their discoveries shed light on contourites, sediment deposits shaped by near-bottom currents that harbor valuable clues about past climate conditions. Henriette Wilckens, the lead scientist, carefully crafted a miniature ocean floor in a large tank at the University of Utrecht. She uses this tank to mimic the currents and sediment flow of a real ocean floor, creating tiny sandcastles to decode the mysteries of the deep. This groundbreaking research opens up a brand-new chapter in ocean exploration, one that is not just academic but also _____ it is helping us understand and care for our planet's most mysterious realms.

- A) practical, as
- B) practical. As
- C) practical; as
- D) practical: as

24. According to the text, *Starry Night* was on display where in 1926?

Starry Night by Vincent van Gogh, one of the most iconic and beloved paintings in the world, has had a journey that is as fascinating as the artwork itself. Painted in 1889 during the artist's stay at the Saint-Paul-de-Mausole asylum in Saint-Rémy-de-Provence, France, the masterpiece began its odyssey in the possession of Vincent's brother, Theo van Gogh, after the artist's tragic death in 1890.

Upon Theo's passing in 1891, the painting then passed to his widow, Johanna van Gogh-Bonger, who worked tirelessly to promote her brother-in-law's work, ensuring that the world would come to appreciate his genius. In 1900, *Starry Night* found a new home in the Galerie Bernheim-Jeune in Paris.

It was only in 1941 that the painting found its permanent residence at the Museum of Modern Art (MoMA) in New York City. Industrialist and art collector Stephen C. Clark acquired it and generously donated it to the museum. Since then, *Starry Night* has become a centerpiece of MoMA's collection, captivating visitors from around the world with its swirling stars and evocative landscape. Its journey through time and ownership has made it a symbol of artistic transcendence, and it is now celebrated as an integral part of the rich tapestry of art history.

- A) Galerie Bernheim-Jeune in Paris
- B) Museum of Modern Art (MoMA) in New York City
- C) Saint-Paul-de-Mausole asylum in Saint-Rémy-de-Provence, France
- D) The Louvre Museum in Paris, France

25. Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

In Nathaniel Hawthorne's *The Scarlet Letter*, the Puritan society of 17th-century New England serves as _____ backdrop for the story of Hester Prynne, a woman condemned for adultery. Hawthorne's novel delves into themes of sin, guilt, and redemption as Hester grapples with the consequences of her actions. The scarlet letter "A" she is forced to wear becomes a symbol of her defiance in the face of societal judgment.

- A) an inconsequential
- B) a traditional
- C) an indifferent
- D) a somber